

SPIDER-MAN

Your friendly neighborhood web-slinger

SPIDER-MAN

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Peter Benjamin Parker
Occupation
Freelance photographer, science teacher
BASE
New York City

HEIGHT

5 ft 10 in

WEIGHT

170 lbs

EYES

Hazel

HAIR

Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Amazing Fantasy #15

(August 1962)

POWERS

Possesses the proportionate strength, speed, agility and reflexes of a spider. Can cling to any surface and generate organic webbing. Also possesses a "spider-sense" that warns him of danger and can psychically align him with his environment. Invented spider-tracers that he can track across the city with his spider-sense.

ALLIES/FOES

ALLIES Ben and May Parker, Mary Jane Parker, Captain America, The Avengers, the Fantastic Four, the X-Men, Eugene "Flash" Thompson, Betty Brant Leeds.

FOES Chameleon, Vulture, Doctor Octopus, Sandman, Kingpin, Green Goblin, Lizard, Electro, Kraven the Hunter, Black Cat, Venom, Mysterio, Carnage, Scorpion, Judas Traveller.

ISSUE #1

While attending a scientific demonstration, Peter Parker was bitten by a spider that had been exposed to radioactivity. Feeling nauseous, the teenager immediately headed home and began to exhibit the most amazing powers—like the ability to stick to walls and crawl up sheer surfaces!



Before gaining his spider-powers, Peter Parker was weaker than most of the kids his age.

Peter Parker's parents died in a plane crash while he was still a child. When they said goodbye at the airport, his parents told him to be a good boy for his Aunt May and Uncle Ben PARKER, who later raised him as their own son. Peter always thought of his Uncle Ben as his best friend. Not only did Ben Parker spend quality time

with the boy, he had a great sense of humor and many hours telling jokes and pulling gags on Peter who developed a real appreciation for quips and pranks. Peter studied hard in school and became an honor student. Although his teachers praised him, the other students had little use for a know-it-all like puny Parker. The girls thought him too quiet, and the boys considered him a wimp.

ORIGIN OF SPIDER-MAN

On the day his life changed forever, Peter went to a science exhibition by himself where he was bitten by a common house spider that had been exposed to a massive dose of radiation. Within a few hours, Peter discovered that he could stick to walls and had gained other amazing arachnid abilities.

Anxious to cash in on his new powers he designed a distinctive costume that concealed his identity, built a pair of web-shooters and went into showbusiness using the Amazing Spider-Man as his stage name.

One night, after a performance, he was walking toward an elevator when a security guard asked him to stop a fleeing man. However, Peter



Peter began to suspect that his powers might be the result of paranormal forces.

MY FAULT -- ALL MY FAULT! IF ONLY I HAD STOPPED HIM WHEN I COULD HAVE! BUT I DIDN'T -- AND NOW -- UNCLE BEN -- IS DEAD...

Parker did nothing and the burglar escaped.

A few days later the same thief murdered Peter's Uncle Ben! Filled with remorse, Peter vowed that he would never allow another

innocent person to suffer because Spider-Man had failed to act. He had learned, in the hardest possible way, to use his great powers in a responsible manner.

HIGH-SCHOOL HERO

Spider-Man soon found himself battling criminals such as the CHAMELEON, the VULTURE, DOCTOR OCTOPUS, the SANDMAN, DOCTOR DOOM, the LIZARD, ELECTRO, MYSTERIO, the GREEN GOBLIN, the SCORPION, and many more. He attempted to join the FANTASTIC FOUR and began a feud with the HUMAN TORCH.

J. Jonah JAMESON, publisher of the *Daily Bugle*, hated masked vigilantes and claimed Spider-Man was a menace to the public. Peter saw an opportunity to exploit Jameson's campaign and began taking pictures of himself as Spider-Man. He was soon supporting himself by selling these pictures to the *Bugle* on a freelance basis.

Peter eventually graduated from Midtown High with the highest scholastic average in the school's history. However, he almost missed the graduation ceremony. While the other seniors were donning caps and gowns, he was busy battling the MOLTEN MAN. He won his fight and arrived at the ceremony just in time to learn that he had won a full scholarship to Empire State University.



The Green Goblin murdered Gwen Stacy, Peter's first true love.

COLLEGE YEARS AND BEYOND

While in college, Peter met Mary Jane Watson (his future wife, see PARKER, MARY JANE), but began to date Gwen STACY. (Gwen would later die tragically at the hands of the Green Goblin.) Peter became best friends with Harry Osborn and later learned that the GREEN GOBLIN was secretly Harry's father Norman. Spider-Man also encountered such villains as KINGPIN, the RHINO, the SHOCKER, SILVERMANE and the PROWLER.

After graduating from college, Peter encountered the acrobatic cat burglar BLACK CAT



High above the streets of Manhattan, Spider-Man tangled with Doc Ock.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Amazing Spider-Man #31-33** Spider-Man battles the Master Planner in order to obtain a rare serum that can save Aunt May's life.
- **Amazing Spider-Man: Fearful Symmetry or Kraven's Last Hunt (tpb)** Kraven the Hunter kidnaps Spider-Man and takes his place in a battle against the deadly Vermin.
- **Amazing Spider-Man: The Saga of the Alien Costume (tpb)** Spider-Man learns that his new black costume is actually an alien symbiote.
- **Amazing Spider-Man vs. Venom (tpb)** Spider-Man meets his match when Venom enters his life.
- **Amazing Spider-Man: Identity Crisis (tpb)** When a \$5 million bounty is placed on his head for a murder he didn't commit, Spider-Man must adopt four new costumed identities to find the real murderer.
- **Amazing Spider-Man: Coming Home (tpb)** Spider-Man meets the man called Ezekiel and learns there may be a lot more to his origin than he ever realized.

(his girlfriend for a while), and the criminals HYDRO-MAN, SPED DEMON and the HOBGOBLIN. He also battled the unstoppable JUGGERNAUT and cosmically-powered FIRELORD. He temporarily donned a new black costume that possessed some additional new powers, but later proved to be an alien symbiote. Meanwhile, his relationship with the beautiful model Mary Jane Watson had grown serious and they were married.

FURTHER DEVELOPMENTS

After leading a European crime cult for many years, Norman Osborn reentered Peter's life. Peter also met a man called Ezekiel who claimed that Spider-Man's powers were the result of magic and not a radioactive spider. Peter later confronted the Queen, who had the power to control insects and she mutated him into a giant

spider. After returning to his human form, Peter learned that his powers and strength had been increased and that he had gained the ability to produce organic webbing. Peter also joined a new AVENGERS team.

After a battle with the mysterious, super-strong, vampire villain Morlun, in which Peter appeared to have been killed, Peter temporarily accepted a new armored costume and a job working for Tony Stark (see IRON MAN). However he has since returned to his traditional look. **TD**



THE ALIEN SUIT

Along with other heroes, Spider-Man was transported to a planet created by a near-omnipotent being called the Beyonder and forced to fight in a series of "Secret Wars". When his original red and blue costume was torn in battle, the web-spinner tried to repair it, but mistakenly activated a device that released a little black ball. The ball spread across him, duplicating the costume worn by the Julia Carpenter Spider-Woman. Spider-Man's new suit could instantly mimic any kind of clothing, could carry his camera and spare change, was equipped with its own web-shooters and possessed a seemingly endless supply of webbing. He eventually discovered that the alien suit was a symbiote with a mind of its own. Spider-Man had to enlist the scientific help of Mr. Fantastic to remove it, using soundwaves at a certain frequency.



Rejected by Spider-Man, the symbiote grafted itself to Eddie Brock to become Venom (top).

